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java.lang.annotation

Annotation Type Retention

```
@Documented
 @Retention(value=RUNTIME)
 @Target(value=ANNOTATION_TYPE)
public @interface Retention
```

Indicates how long annotations with the annotated type are to be retained. If no Retention annotation is present on an annotation type declaration, the retention policy defaults to `RetentionPolicy.CLASS`.

A Retention meta-annotation has effect only if the meta-annotated type is used directly for annotation. It has no effect if the meta-annotated type is used as a member type in another annotation type.

Since:

1.5

See *The Java™ Language Specification*:

9.6.3.2 @Retention

Required Element Summary

Required Elements

Modifier and Type	Required Element	Description
RetentionPolicy	value	Returns the retention policy.

Element Detail

value

```
public abstract RetentionPolicy value
```

Returns the retention policy.

Returns:

the retention policy

Submit a bug or feature

For further API reference and developer documentation, see Java SE Documentation. That documentation contains more detailed, developer-targeted descriptions, with conceptual overviews, definitions of terms, workarounds, and working code examples.

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